

PRD: n8n-Only Workflow Automation for instacar.gr Financial Document Collection via Email

TL;DR

This Product Requirements Document (PRD) specifies the design, requirements, and workflow for seamless end-to-end automation of financial document collection and storage for instacar.gr using n8n. When customers email financial documents to drive@instacar.gr (as a reply to their booking offer), n8n automatically identifies the sender via the instacar API, validates their user status (existing or not), extracts attachments, calls the upload endpoint to store them securely, updates the booking status, and notifies agents (via Slack) — all without manual document handling. The deliverable is a scalable n8n-powered solution that eliminates manual document downloading/uploading by agents while keeping agents informed of customer document submissions during the "Pending Credit Check" state.

Goals

Business Goals

- Eliminate 100% of manual document handling currently performed by agents who download attachments and upload to instafleet
- Reduce document processing time from hours/days to <2 minutes through instant automated workflows
- Scale effortlessly to handle 50-100+ emails per day with multiple attachments each
- Improve agent productivity by freeing them from repetitive document handling tasks while keeping them informed
- Reduce credit check delays by instantly making documents available to the system upon email receipt
- Maintain agent awareness of customer document submissions for timely credit check processing

User Goals

- Seamless document submission via familiar email interface (reply to booking email to drive@instacar.gr)
- Simple, flexible submission options without learning new systems (can use my.instacar.gr upload or email)
- No confusion about where to send documents (clear instructions in booking email)

Non-Goals

- No automatic validation or customer notifications about document success/failure
- No customer-facing error handling via email (agents handle all customer communication)
- No document quality checks (blur detection, completeness validation) in Phase 1
- No integration with credit check systems beyond storage (handled separately by agents)
- No support for document types beyond PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PNG, JPG, JPEG
- No customer portal showing document status (handled by my.instacar.gr separately)
- No Gemini AI document categorisation in Phase 1 (confirmed out of scope)
- OCR / field extraction for billing details: status TBD — in discussion via separate email thread

User Stories

Persona	User Story
Customer	As a customer, I want to reply to my booking email with my financial documents instead of upload them on my.instacar.gr portal
Customer	As a customer, I want to send documents directly to drive@instacar.gr if I've lost the booking email, so I have a reliable fallback method.
Customer	As a customer, I want the document submission process to be simple and not worry about uploading docs in a portal etc

Agent	As a sales agent, I no longer want to manually download email attachments and upload them to instafleet
Agent	As an agent, I want to be notified immediately when a customer submits documents via email, so I know their application is progressing and I can prioritize credit checks.
Agent	As a sales agent, I want to know which customer sent documents and how many files they uploaded, so I can quickly assess if they've submitted everything required.
Agent	As a sales agent, I want to be notified when documents come from unknown senders, so I can investigate and manually match them to the correct customer.

End-to-End Workflow & Automation

End-to-End Workflow & Automation

1. Email Monitoring - Booking Replies Only

Critical requirement: n8n monitors only replies to booking confirmation emails in the drive@instacar.gr inbox, not all incoming emails.

Implementation:

- n8n Gmail trigger monitors drive@instacar.gr inbox for emails that are part of existing email threads (replies)
- Email subject contains the booking ID (e.g. JNEDNKI8YJ) — this is now embedded in subject line by design
- Only processes emails with attachments present

What gets ignored (not scanned at all):

- ❑ New emails sent directly to drive@instacar.gr (not part of booking thread)
- ❑ Emails without booking ID in the subject / thread
- ❑ Replies without attachments
- ❑ All other inbox emails (newsletters, support requests, spam, etc.)

Result: Dramatically reduced processing load: only 50-100 booking-related replies scanned per day instead of entire inbox (potentially 400+ emails).

Note: Emails where the user sends directly (not as a reply) are a known edge case. Handling these would impact Google API rate limits and is NOT included in Phase 1.

2. Customer & Booking Identification

Step 1: Extract booking ID

- **Primary:** Extract booking_id from email subject line (pattern e.g. JNEDNKI8YJ) — now embedded in subject by design
- Fallback: Search email body for booking ID pattern
- Store booking_id for use in all subsequent API calls

Step 2: Identify customer via API

- Call POST /api/v1/integrations/users with sender email address
- If user found: retrieve user_id, customer_name, and confirm booking association
- If user NOT found: trigger "Unknown User" flow (see Error Handling)

Important: No validation occurs in Phase 1. The system simply identifies who sent the email and which booking it relates to.

3. Attachment Processing - No Filtering in Phase 1

Simplified approach: All attachments are processed and uploaded without filtering.

For each attachment:

- Extract filename, file size, file type
- Determine document type integer (see Document Type Mapping section)
- Call POST /api/v1/integrations/bookings/{bookingId}/documents with file + type field
- Exclude email signatures (e.g. small JPG/PNG files typical of email signatures)

No filtering rules in Phase 1:

- No file type restrictions
- No size limits
- No filename pattern exclusions

Rationale: Keep Phase 1 simple. Agents can review all uploaded files and determine what's relevant. Filtering logic can be added in Phase 2 based on real-world usage patterns.

4. Document Storage

Storage is handled entirely by the instacar backend. n8n calls POST `/api/v1/integrations/bookings/{ID}/documents` with the bookingId in the path — the backend manages all S3 paths, folder structure, and metadata. n8n does NOT manage storage directly.

5. Booking Status Update

After all documents are successfully uploaded, n8n must call:

```
PATCH /api/v1/integrations/bookings/{bookingId}
Body: { "status": 3 }
```

This sets the booking to "documents uploaded" status in the instacar system.

6. Agent Notifications

Notification sent to: Slack channel #n8n (Channel ID: C0AHEQ1GCLR)

Notification timing: Immediately after all documents are stored and booking status is updated

Key points:

- No customer notifications are sent (only agent notifications)
- Agents receive all context needed to take action
- Unknown senders trigger special alert requiring manual intervention
- Normal notification includes: customer name, booking ID, number of documents uploaded, link to customer profile in instafleet

Note: The #n8n channel may change before go-live. Build the channel ID as a configurable parameter.

7. No Customer Communication

The system does not send any automated emails to customers:

- ❑ No confirmation that documents were received
- ❑ No error messages
- ❑ No validation failure notices
- ❑ No status updates

8. Error Handling

Customer email not in database (unknown sender):

- Send Slack notification to #n8n channel with: "Manual Action Required", sender email, number of attachments, possible booking_id
- Do NOT upload any documents
- Do NOT call any upload or status update endpoints
- Agent manually investigates and uploads the documents

No attachments in reply:

- Ignore the email completely (no processing, no notification)
- These are likely just text replies from customers

General errors (API failures, etc.):

- Send error notification to a dedicated Slack error channel (TBD — build channel as configurable env variable)
- Include error type, affected booking_id, sender email, and timestamp
- Do not silently swallow errors

API Reference & Credentials

Staging host: `hq-api.staging.instacar.dev`

Authentication: All requests require header `x-api-token`:
`2f1336b3-32f5-4c0e-b773-965219be0884`

Endpoints

Method	Endpoint	Purpose
POST	<code>/api/v1/integrations/users</code>	Look up user by email address + validate bookingIds
POST	<code>/api/v1/integrations/bookings/{ID}/documents</code>	Upload document for a booking. Backend handles S3 storage. Requires file + type (integer) field.
PATCH	<code>/api/v1/integrations/bookings/{ID}</code>	Update booking status. Send <code>{ "status": 3 }</code> after all docs are uploaded.

Document Types & Integer Mapping

The upload endpoint accepts a type field (integer) per document. Full mapping:

Integer	Document Type
1	(financial) Τελευταίο Εκκαθαριστικό
2	(financial) Μισθοδοσία
3	(financial) Α3
4	(financial) Εκκαθαριστικό
5	(financial) 2 ετών δημοσιευμένος ισολογισμός
6	(financial) Ε3
7	(financial) Ε5
8	(financial) 2 ετών επικυρωμένος ισολογισμός
9	(financial) Επικυρωμένος ισολογισμός
10	Λογαριασμός ΔΕΚΟ
11	(financial) Περιοδικές Δηλώσεις ΦΠΑ
12	(financial) Φόρμα Ν

Document types required per customer category

Customer Category	Required Documents
Ιδιώτης (Individual)	Τελευταίο Εκκαθαριστικό (1) • Ε3 (6) • Περιοδικές Δηλώσεις ΦΠΑ (11)
Εταιρείες (Ατομική Επιχείρηση, ΙΚΕ, ΟΕ, ΕΕ, ΕΠΕ, ΑΕ, Άλλο)	Τελευταίο Έντυπο Ε3 (6) • Περιοδικές Δηλώσεις ΦΠΑ (11) • Τελευταίο Έντυπο Ν (12)

Note: For Λογαριασμός ΔΕΚΟ (type 10): no standardised document format exists as each utility company uses a different layout.

Open Items

Item	Status / Notes
OCR / Field extraction for billing details	In discussion for Phase 1. Requirements in separate email thread. Design to allow this module to be added later.
Error Slack channel	TBD. Not a blocker. Build channel ID as configurable env variable.
Agent notification Slack channel	Currently #n8n (C0AHEQ1GCLR). May change before go-live.
Customer type inference	Confirm how to determine Ιδιώτης vs. Εταιρείες from the POST /api/v1/integrations/users response.
Test documents for staging	Sample PDF, PNG, DOCX files to be provided for staging environment testing.

User Experience

Customer Journey

Step 1: Customer receives booking confirmation email from instacar at drive@instacar.gr containing booking details and instructions: "Reply to this email with your documents attached". The subject line now contains the booking_id.

Step 2: Customer clicks "Reply", attaches their financial documents (PDFs, images, Word files), and sends

Step 3: Behind the scenes (invisible to customer), n8n processes the reply, identifies the user via the instacar API, uploads all documents, and updates booking status — all within minutes

Step 4: Customer receives no confirmation (by design). They trust documents were received.

Step 5: Agent reviews documents and contacts customer about next steps if needed

Agent Journey

Step 1: Agent receives Slack notification in #n8n channel showing customer name (or "Unknown Sender"), booking ID, and number of documents uploaded

Step 2: Agent clicks link to view customer profile in instafleet directly

Step 3a: If customer identified → Agent reviews documents and proceeds with credit check. Booking is already marked as "documents uploaded" (status 3).

Step 3b: If unknown sender → Agent investigates email, identifies correct customer, manually uploads documents to instafleet

Step 4: Agent contacts customer personally about application status (approved, need more docs, etc.)

PRD v2 — Updated April 2026 based on email communications. Changes highlighted throughout: API endpoints, Slack channel, document type mapping, booking status update step.